

Loading Corpora in AntConc 4.2.4

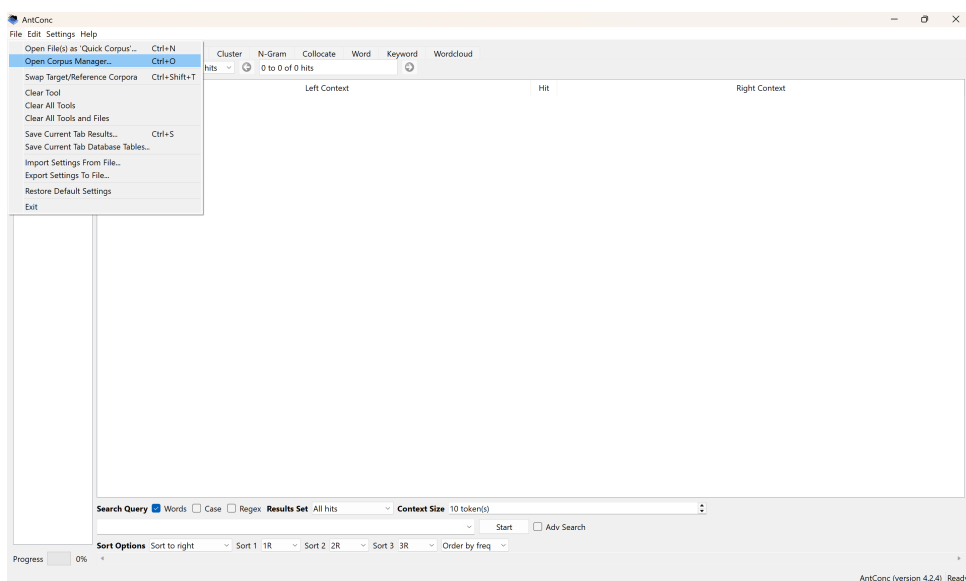
Visual Step-by-Step Guide

Before you start, make sure you have these two files saved on your computer:

`kong_seg.txt` (the 講 corpus — Target)
`sue_seg.txt` (the 説 corpus — Reference)

Part 1 — Load the 講 Corpus as Target

Step 1. Open AntConc. Go to **File** → **Open Corpus Manager**.



Step 2. The Corpus Manager opens. Under **Corpus Source**, click **Raw File(s)** to select it.

AntConc - Corpus Manager

Corpus Source

☐ Corpus Database ☒ Raw File(s) ☐ Word List

Raw Files Corpus Builder

Corpus name

Corpus files

No. of files

Basic Settings

► Indexer, Encoding, Token Definition, Row Processor

Advanced Options

Target Corpus Reference Corpus

Corpus name

Description

Step 3. In the **Corpus name** field, clear the default text and type: **kong**

AntConc - Corpus Manager

Corpus Source

☐ Corpus Database ☒ Raw File(s) ☐ Word List

Raw Files Corpus Builder

Corpus name

Corpus files

No. of files

Basic Settings

► Indexer, Encoding, Token Definition, Row Processor

Advanced Options

Target Corpus Reference Corpus

Corpus name

Description

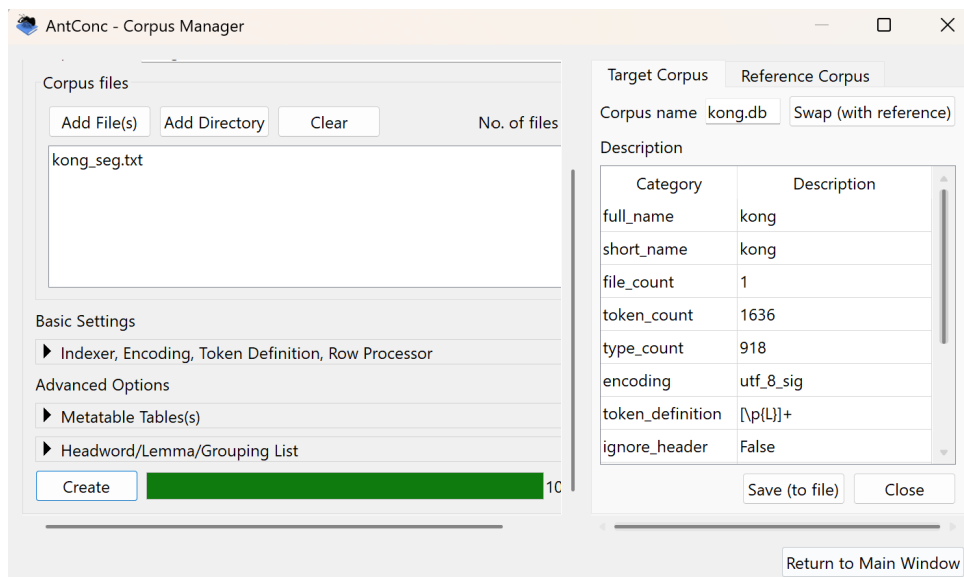
Step 4. Click **Add File(s)**. A file browser opens. Navigate to your folder, select **kong_seg.txt**, and click **Open**.

The screenshot shows the 'AntConc - Corpus Manager' window. On the left, under 'Corpus Source', the 'Raw File(s)' radio button is selected. Below it, the 'Raw Files Corpus Builder' section has a 'Corpus name' field containing 'kong'. The 'Corpus files' section is empty, with buttons for 'Add File(s)', 'Add Directory', and 'Clear'. A 'No. of files' label is next to the list. At the bottom left, 'Basic Settings' and 'Advanced Options' are visible. On the right, the 'Target Corpus' tab is active, showing a 'Corpus name' field and a 'Description' text area. A 'Swap (with reference)' button is next to the name field. At the bottom right of the right panel are 'Save (to file)' and 'Close' buttons. A 'Return to Main Window' button is at the very bottom right of the window.

Step 5. The filename appears in the *Corpus files* box. Scroll down until you see the **Create** button at the bottom left. Click it. A green progress bar will run. Wait until it finishes.

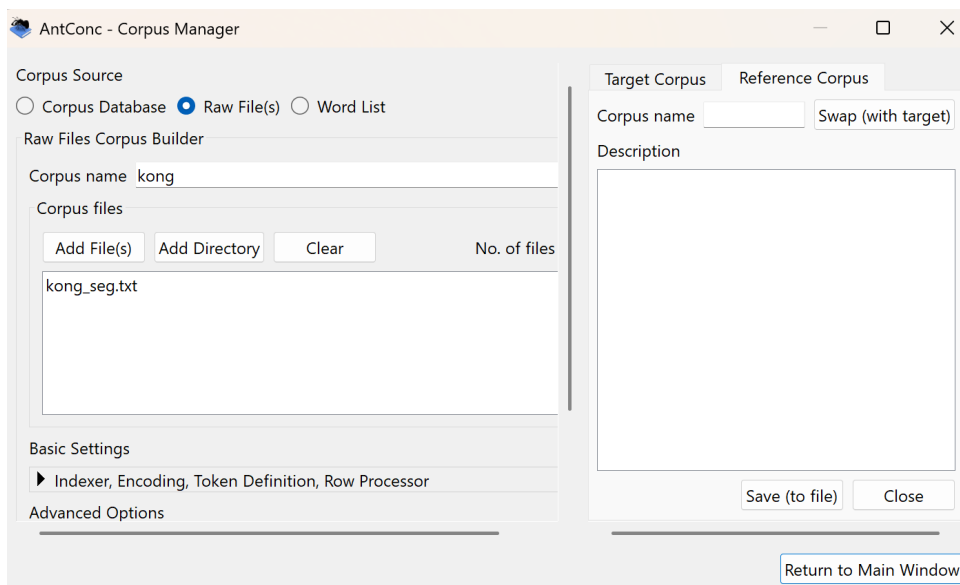
This screenshot shows the same 'AntConc - Corpus Manager' window after the file 'kong_seg.txt' has been added. In the 'Corpus files' list, 'kong_seg.txt' is now present. The 'Add File(s)' button is still visible. The 'Create' button at the bottom left of the left panel is now enabled. The right panel remains the same, with the 'Target Corpus' tab active. The 'Return to Main Window' button is still at the bottom right.

Step 6. When the progress bar finishes, the right panel fills in with corpus details. Click **Save (to file)** on the right panel. Save the file as **kong.db** in your course folder.



Part 2 — Load the 説 Corpus as Reference

Step 7. Click the **Reference Corpus** tab in the top right of the Corpus Manager window.



Step 8. In the **Corpus name** field, type: **sue**

The screenshot shows the 'AntConc - Corpus Manager' window. On the left, under 'Corpus Source', the 'Raw File(s)' radio button is selected. Below it, the 'Raw Files Corpus Builder' section has a 'Corpus name' field containing 'sue'. The 'Corpus files' list contains one entry: 'kong_seg.txt'. At the bottom left, there are sections for 'Basic Settings' (with a dropdown for 'Indexer, Encoding, Token Definition, Row Processor') and 'Advanced Options'. On the right, the 'Target Corpus' tab is active, showing a 'Corpus name' field and a 'Description' text area. A 'Swap (with target)' button is next to the 'Corpus name' field. At the bottom right of the right panel are 'Save (to file)' and 'Close' buttons. A 'Return to Main Window' button is at the very bottom right of the window.

Step 9. Important: the *Corpus files* box still shows the previous file. Click **Clear** to remove it before adding the new file.

This screenshot is identical to the previous one, but the 'Clear' button in the 'Corpus files' section is now highlighted with a blue border, indicating it should be clicked. The 'kong_seg.txt' file remains in the list, and the 'Return to Main Window' button is still at the bottom right.

Step 10. Click **Add File(s)**. Navigate to your folder, select **sue_seg.txt**, and click **Open**.

AntConc - Corpus Manager

Corpus Source

☐ Corpus Database ☒ Raw File(s) ☐ Word List

Raw Files Corpus Builder

Corpus name sue

Corpus files

Add File(s) Add Directory Clear No. of files

Basic Settings

Indexer, Encoding, Token Definition, Row Processor

Advanced Options

Target Corpus Reference Corpus

Corpus name Swap (with target)

Description

Save (to file) Close

Return to Main Window

Step 11. Scroll down and click **Create**. Wait for the green progress bar to finish.

AntConc - Corpus Manager

Corpus files

Add File(s) Add Directory Clear No. of files

sue_seg.txt

Basic Settings

Indexer, Encoding, Token Definition, Row Processor

Advanced Options

Metatable Tables(s)

Headword/Lemma/Grouping List

Create

Target Corpus Reference Corpus

Corpus name Swap (with target)

Description

Save (to file) Close

Return to Main Window

Step 12. When finished, the right panel shows the corpus details. Click **Save (to file)** and save as **sue.db** in your course folder.

The screenshot shows the 'AntConc - Corpus Manager' window. On the left, the 'Corpus files' list contains 'sue_seg.txt'. Below it, 'Basic Settings' and 'Advanced Options' are visible. The 'Create' button is highlighted in green. On the right, the 'Target Corpus' tab is active, showing 'Corpus name: sue.db' and a 'Swap (with target)' button. Below this is a 'Description' table with the following data:

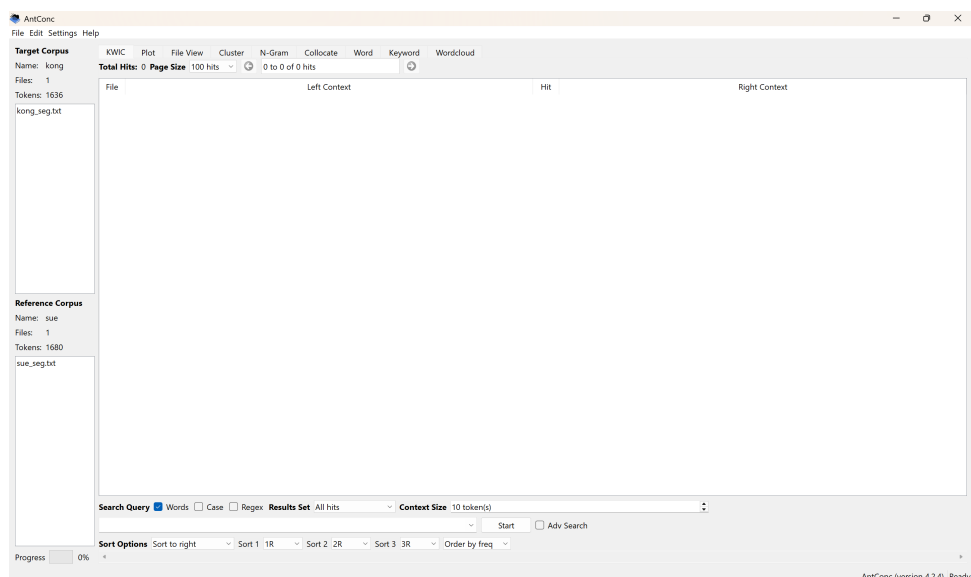
Category	Description
full_name	sue
short_name	sue
file_count	1
token_count	1680
type_count	836
encoding	utf_8_sig
token_definition	[p(L)]+
ignore_header	False

At the bottom right of the right panel are buttons for 'Save (to file)' and 'Close'. A 'Return to Main Window' button is located at the very bottom of the window.

Step 13. Click **Return to Main Window**.

This screenshot is identical to the one above, showing the 'AntConc - Corpus Manager' window with the same corpus details for 'sue.db'. The 'Return to Main Window' button at the bottom right is highlighted with a blue border, indicating it is the next step in the process.

Step 14. Both corpora are now loaded. The left panel shows **Target Corpus** (kong) at the top and **Reference Corpus** (sue) below. You are ready to start searching.



Before You Search — One Important Setting

Uncheck the “Words” box in the Search Query bar.

At the bottom of the main window you will see a **Words** checkbox next to the search bar. **Make sure it is unchecked** before searching.

If it is checked, AntConc only finds the search term when it appears as a completely standalone token. Many uses of 講 and 說 will be missed. With it unchecked, AntConc finds the character wherever it appears in the text.

Quick Reference

File	Role	Contents
kong_seg.txt	Target corpus (raw)	200 sentences with 講
sue_seg.txt	Reference corpus (raw)	200 sentences with 說
kong.db	Target corpus (saved)	Reload instantly next time
sue.db	Reference corpus (saved)	Reload instantly next time

Next time you open AntConc, skip the steps above. Go to **File → Open Corpus Manager**, select **Corpus Database** under Corpus Source, and load **kong.db** and **sue.db** directly. No need to re-import the .txt files.